

# Case Playbook

## Product

For each problem, identify what type of problem is being posed, solve the original question asked, and complete any follow-on questions.

### Question 1:

Assume you are a product manager at a rideshare company. Customers use an app to call for a ride and the driver picks the customer up and drops them off at the destination.

You are the part of the team that is focused on the ride experience and additional monetization. You are focused on ensuring that customers have a pleasant in-car experience and you want to identify additional revenue opportunities during the car ride.

### Business context/strategy

**Q1.a** How might the company increase revenue from the customer in addition to the ride itself without hindering the customer experience?

**Q1.b** How would you increase the revenue for the company from sources other than the customer?

The answers are for illustration only. You can elaborate further and/or take a different route. Quick tips for strategy questions:

- Think about all the different levers of business value, the different customer segments that can contribute to and receive value from the each lever
- Structure your answer before speaking
- Be bold and think big
- Share all of your ideas
- Think about the impact to the customer - positive or negative and call it out

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**1.a** There are a number of ways to increase revenue from the customer in addition to what they pay for the ride itself.

- A subscription service that gives them more value such as priority pick up, low waiting fees, additional services such as ability to preset the music and temperature
- Adding a tablet in every car to display ads. But, the tablet just for ads will be annoying, so the tablet can help customers do more like play games, pick music
- Charge a destination change fee if they change or add multiple stops
- Allow the driver to sell things to the customer like water or soda that they may need during the ride

**2.b** There are multiple sources to earn additional revenue.

- We can provide a premier subscription tier for drivers that gives them priority over other drivers, matches them first with the best customers, gives them exclusive discounts for car maintenance, and even access to low cost rental cars when their own car isn't available
- Monetize the traffic data by selling ride data to others. We need to be careful to make sure that the data shared has the customer and the driver opting to share and that the data is anonymized
- Stocking the car with packages that need to be delivered across town to create more value to the driver and the company. We need to be mindful that the package delivery doesn't impact the wait times and match rates for customers and drivers

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### Question 2:

I'd like your input on a technical implementation of a feature on our backlog:

**Q2.a** You want to implement ads during the customer's ride on a tablet available in the car and make it relevant to the customer. What technical components would you need to build this feature?

**Q2.b** You want to build a feature that allows the customer to buy select available things that the driver can sell (like water, candy, etc.). What technical components would you need to build this feature?

You don't need to answer this question in a deeply technical manner. You should think about high level components that might be needed to make the experience work. Quick tips for this question

1. Think about the end-end customer experience
2. Articulate what you'd need as technical components to make the experience work
3. Think about what kind of data will be needed and how the data will be used
4. Use pen and paper to draw the steps in the customer experience, the high level architecture, and then identify the components needed

### Q2.a

1. We will need the ability to display ads to the customer. Sometimes the car might go through areas without network coverage and should have offline ads to display, perhaps download ads at the beginning of the ride
2. We will need a component that has all available ads and a component to decide what ads are relevant to the customer. This could be based on the location from/to location of the customer - example, if the customer is going to the grocery store, then we can show them ads about products available at the store
3. We need a component that tracks which ads were played to which customers to report back to the advertiser
4. We need a component for the advertisers to select the right customer profile to display ads to
5. We need backup content to show if there are not relevant ads available to the customer
6. We need to give the customer the ability to opt out of sharing their data with advertisers

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### Q2.b

1. We need an eCommerce store component for the customer to browse and buy from the driver. This could be available in the app itself or on a device inside the car. Ideally, we show the customer what's available before they are picked up
2. We need a component that allows the driver to select available items and quantity
3. We need a component that tracks purchases made and keeps the available inventory accurate
4. We need the ability to accept payments from the customer, pay the driver, and manage refunds

### Question 3:

Q3 Now you have A/B tested a feature that displays relevant ads in video without audio and video with audio to the customer during the ride and here are the results. Take a look at the data and tell me what conclusions you can draw.

| Format                                                                                                  | Views   | View completion rate | Clicks | Purchases |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|----------------------|--------|-----------|
| Video without audio  | 100,000 | 10%                  | 6000   | 100       |
| Video with audio                                                                                        | 100,000 | 8%                   | 4000   | 350       |

### Quick tips for the data analysis question:

1. Understand what metric ultimately matters and look at the data with that lens
2. Parse %s from absolute numbers and identify what matters more
3. Identify if the sample sets are similar and if the test is a good setup
4. Get curious and call out what you'd want to analyze further or understand more about

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### Answer:

Looking at the data and the experience, ultimately, the purchase is what I'd need important. Based on that the video with audio seems like the clear winner. However, there are things I want to understand more.

The view completion rate and the clicks are lower than the video without audio. I'd want to learn more about if the audio did indeed play or if the customers turned down the volume.

In the video without audio format, the clicks didn't convert as much. I'd want to understand if there was something broken in the experience after the click.

### Question 4:

You're ready to build the ads feature, but you have a dependency on another team to make a data model change. The other team has said they can't get to your request for another year. You don't want to wait 6 months to start your team's work. To move the project forward, you've set up a meeting with the leadership of the other team and you're hoping to convince them to start the work sooner.

How would you prepare for this meeting?

### Quick tips for the dependency question:

1. Get creative. This is a great way to show how you'd overcome challenges.
2. Find ways to create win-win scenarios for everyone involved.
3. Think about the company's goals and work down to your product goals.

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### Answer:

1. I'd create a document/slide deck with the below:
  - a. Clearly outline the value my feature is looking to deliver and research/tests I have to back it up
  - b. Explain how my feature directly contributes to the department and company goals
  - c. Show how the other team working on my feature actually helps them deliver value
2. Identify trade offs the other team has to make and what the trade offs mean in terms of business value or goal contribution
3. Show why we need to work on my feature now and why it can't wait a year with market and competitor research, and missed opportunity cost
4. I'll partner with the product manager of the other team to create a win-win outcome for both teams and show how my team can help them delivery on future priorities

You will be presented with a design mock up and asked to critique the experience. Tips for answering the question:

1. Put yourself in the shoes of the user and ask what's not working
2. As the PM, what do you want the user to accomplish and ask yourself how this experience helps to get there
3. Think about metrics you want to measure and how the experience reduces friction to move them